【英语一】 2007 阅读 Text3

基础大纲词 精读补充词 核心重难词
常考大纲短语 核心精读短语 考点长难句

P1 ① During the past generation, the American middle-class family that once could **count on** (依靠) hard work and **fair play** (公平竞争) to keep itself financially secure (安全的) has **been transformed by** (被…所改变) economic (经济的) risk (风险) and new realities (现实). ② Now a **pink slip** (解雇通知书), a bad diagnosis (诊断结果), or a disappearing (失踪的) spouse (配偶) can reduce a family from solidly middle class to newly poor in **a few** (几个) months.

①在过去的这一代，美国中产阶级家庭曾经可以依靠勤奋工作和公平竞争来维持自身的经济安全，如今却已被经济风险和新的现实所改变。②如今，一张解雇通知、一份糟糕的诊断书，或者配偶的突然离去，都可能在短短数月内将一个原本稳固的中产家庭推向新贫阶层。

P2 ① In just one generation, **millions of** (数百万) mothers have gone to work, transforming (改变) basic family economics (经济状况). ② Scholars (学者), policymakers, and critics (批评家) of all stripes (种类) have debated (争论) the social implications (影响) of these changes, but few have **looked at** (考虑) the **side effect** (副作用): family risk (风险) has risen **as well** (也). ③ Today's families have budgeted **to the limits** (到极限) of their new two-paycheck status (状态). ④ **As a result** (因此，结果是…), they have lost the parachute (保护伞) they once had in times of financial (经济的) setback (挫折)— a back-up earner (usually Mom) who could go into the workforce if the primary (原本的) earner got **laid off** (解雇/下岗) or **fell sick** (患病). ⑤ This "added-worker effect" could support the **safety net** (安全保障) offered by **unemployment insurance** (失业保险) or **disability insurance** (伤残保险) to help families **weather bad times** (渡过难关). ⑥ But today, a disruption (损失) to family fortunes can **no longer** (不再) be **made up** (弥补) with extra income from an otherwise-stay-at-home partner.

①仅在一代人的时间里，数百万母亲走上了工作岗位，从根本上改变了家庭经济。②各路学者、政策制定者和评论家都在争论这些变化的社会影响，但很少有人关注其副作用：家庭面临的风险也随之上升。③如今的家庭已按照双份薪水的新局面，将预算做到了收入所能支撑的极限。④因此，他们失去了过去遭遇经济困境时的那把“保护伞”——一个后备收入来源（通常是母亲），一旦家庭主要经济支柱失业或病倒，她便可以外出工作。⑤“附加劳动者效应”能够增强失业保险或残疾保险所提供的安全网，从而帮助家庭安然渡过难关。⑥但如今，家庭财务若遭变故，已无法再靠一个原本可以留在家里的配偶外出挣得的额外收入来弥补。

P3 ① During the same period, families have been **asked to** (让某人做某事) absorb (承担) much more risk (风险) in their retirement income. ② Steelworkers, airline (航空公司) employees, and now those in the auto industry are joining millions of families who must **worry about** (担忧) **interest rates** (利率), **stock market** (股市) fluctuation (波动), and the harsh (残酷的) reality (现实) that they may outlive their retirement money. ③ For much of the past year, President Bush campaigned (发起行动) to move **Social Security** (社会保障金（政府定期向贫穷、失业、患病等人发放）) to a savings-account model, with retirees trading much or all of their guaranteed (保障性的) payments (支付) for payments (支付) **depending on** (依靠) investment (投资) returns. ④ For younger families, the picture is not any better. ⑤ Both the absolute (绝对的) cost of healthcare and the share of it borne (承担) by families have risen— and newly fashionable (流行的) health-savings plans are spreading from legislative halls to Wal-Mart workers, with much higher deductibles (减额) and a large new dose (量) of investment (投资) risk (风险) for families' future healthcare. ⑥ Even demographics (人口统计数据) are **working against** (对…造成不利) the **middle class** (中产阶级/中等收入阶层) family, as the odds (可能性) of having a weak elderly parent— and all the attendant (随之而来的) need for physical (身体的) and financial (经济的) assistance (帮助)— have jumped eightfold in just one generation.

①同一时期，家庭在退休收入方面还被要求承担更多的风险。②钢铁工人、航空公司员工，如今又加上汽车行业的从业者，都加入了数以百万计的家庭行列，他们不得不担心利率变化、股市波动，以及一个残酷的现实：他们可能会比自己的退休金活得还要久（退休金难以支撑终老）。③在过去一年的大部分时间里，布什总统一直在推动把社会保障转向储蓄账户模式，即退休人员将其全部或大部分固定给付养老金，换为依赖于投资回报的给付方式。④对于年轻家庭而言，情况同样不容乐观。⑤医疗保健的绝对成本以及由家庭承担的那部分份额都在上升——新近流行的健康储蓄计划正从立法机构推行到沃尔玛的员工，这些计划伴随着远高于以往的免赔额，并为家庭未来的医疗保障带来了大量新增的投资风险。⑥就连人口结构也在与中产阶级家庭作对：家中有一位体弱年迈的父母——以及随之而来的对身体照料和经济支持的种种需求——的概率，在仅仅一代人的时间里就飙升了八倍。

P4 ① From the middle-class family perspective, much of this, understandably, looks far less like an opportunity to exercise more financial responsibility, and a good deal more like a frightening acceleration of the wholesale shift of financial risk onto their already overburdened shoulders. ② The financial fallout has begun, and the political fallout may not be far behind.

①在中产家庭看来，这一切非但谈不上是展现财务担当的契机，反而更像是在以惊人的速度，把所有的财务风险全盘甩给他们早已负重累累的双肩——而他们的这种担忧完全是可以理解的。②经济上的后果

Q1. Today's double-income families are at greater financial risk **in that**_____.

细节题

[A] the safety net they used to enjoy has disappeared

[B] their chances of being **laid off** have greatly increased

[C] they **are** more **vulnerable to** changes in family economics

[D] they **are deprived of** unemployment or disability insurance

如今的双收入家庭面临着更大的经济风险，因为_____。

A.他们曾经享有的安全网消失了

B.他们失业的可能性大大增加了

C.他们更容易受家庭经济情况变化的打击

D.他们不再享受失业或伤残保险

Q2. As a result of President Bush's reform, retired people may have_____.

细节题

[A] a higher sense of security

[B] less secured payments

[C] less chance to invest

[D] a guaranteed future

根据布什总统的改革，退休人员可能会_____。

A.比以前更有安全感

B.收入没有以前有保障

C.投资机会更少了

D.未来有保障

Q3. According to the author, health-savings plans will_____.

细节题

[A] help reduce the cost of healthcare

[B] popularize among the middle class

[C] **compensate for** the reduced pensions

[D] increase the families' investment risk

作者看来，健康储蓄计划会_____。

A.有助于减少医疗保健费用

B.在中产阶级里受欢迎

C.补偿减少的退休金

D.增加家庭的投资风险

Q4. It can be inferred from the last paragraph that_____.

推理题

[A] financial risks **tend to** outweigh political risks

[B] the middle class may face greater political challenges

[C] financial problems may **bring about** political problems

[D] financial responsibility is an indicator of political status

根据最后一段，可以推断_____。

A.经济风险往往比政治风险更严重

B.中产阶级可能面临更大的政治挑战

C.经济问题可能带来政治问题

D.经济责任是政治地位的指标

Q5. Which of the following is the best title for this text?

主旨题

[A] The Middle Class on the Alert

[B] The Middle Class on the Cliff

[C] The Middle Class in Conflict

[D] The Middle Class in Ruins

下列哪项是本文最合适的标题？

A.警觉的中产阶级

B.危机边缘的中产阶级

C.冲突之中的中产阶级

D.废墟中的中产阶级